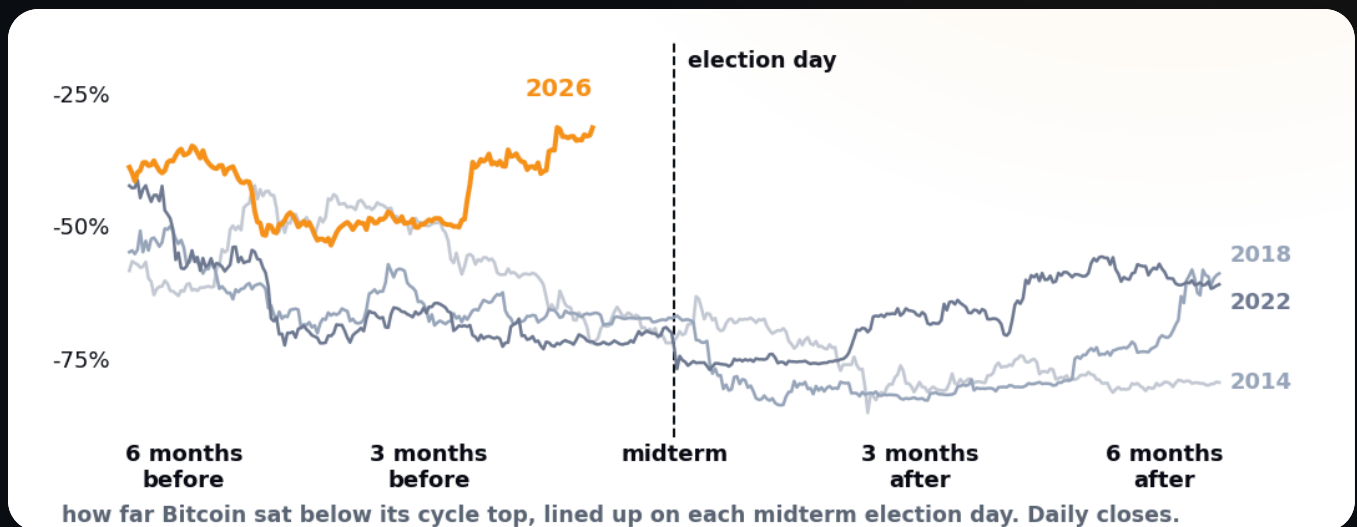


THE MIDTERM STUDY

Everyone says Bitcoin bottoms after the US midterm elections. The next one is 3 November 2026. I checked every midterm since Bitcoin existed, and every one for stocks since 1950.

The stock-market record the idea comes from, the three Bitcoin bears that had a midterm, how far price fell first, why it is the halving calendar and not politics, and what makes 2026 different.



3 of 3

Bitcoin bears bottomed after election day

19 of 19

times stocks were higher a year after a midterm

125 days

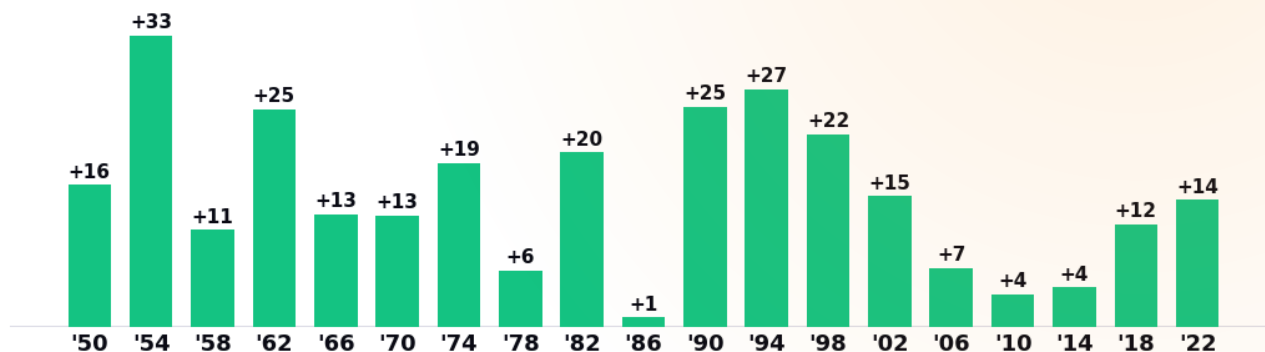
before the midterm, the 2026 low so far

Educational, not financial advice. Three Bitcoin midterms is a very small sample, and this guide says so on every page where it matters.



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WHERE THE IDEA COMES FROM



S&P 500, % change in the 12 months after every midterm election day since 1950.

The S&P 500 was higher 12 months after election day in all 19 midterms since 1950, with a typical gain of 14.5% and a smallest gain of 1.1% in 1986. It was also higher 6 months after in all 19. In 18 of the 19, the midterm year's low came before election day, not after it.

MIDTERM	6 MONTHS AFTER	12 MONTHS AFTER
1950	+17%	+16%
1954	+19%	+33%
1958	+12%	+11%
1962	+19%	+25%
1966	+16%	+13%
1970	+23%	+13%
1974	+18%	+19%
1978	+6%	+6%
1982	+18%	+20%
1986	+20%	+1%

STOCKS

EVERY MIDTERM SINCE 1950

MIDTERM	6 MONTHS AFTER	12 MONTHS AFTER
1990	+21%	+25%
1994	+12%	+27%
1998	+20%	+22%
2002	+2%	+15%
2006	+9%	+7%
2010	+14%	+4%
2014	+4%	+4%
2018	+5%	+12%
2022	+8%	+14%

S&P 500 index closes, measured from election day. Typical = median.

This is one of the cleanest records in market history, and it is why the midterm shows up in so many Bitcoin forecasts. But stocks have 19 examples. Bitcoin has three.

BITCOIN

THE THREE BITCOIN MIDTERMS

YEAR	ELECTION DAY	CLOSE THAT DAY	BEAR LOW	LOW CAME	DROP FROM ELECTION DAY
2014	4 Nov 2014	\$330	14 Jan 2015	71 days after	-54%
2018	6 Nov 2018	\$6,448	15 Dec 2018	39 days after	-52%
2022	8 Nov 2022	\$18,550	21 Nov 2022	13 days after	-17%

Lows on intraday wicks, Bitstamp. Drop measured from the election-day close to the low.

All three bear markets that contained a midterm bottomed after election day, within 71 days. But the price on election day was not the bottom. Bitcoin fell another 54% in 2014, 52% in 2018 and 17% in 2022 before the low was in.

YEAR	1 MONTH AFTER	3 MONTHS AFTER	6 MONTHS AFTER	12 MONTHS AFTER	NEXT CALENDAR YEAR
2014	+12%	-31%	-29%	+24%	2015, +34%
2018	-47%	-47%	-11%	+45%	2019, +94%
2022	-7%	+25%	+49%	+92%	2023, +156%

Close to close from election day. The 2010 midterm is left out, Bitcoin traded at 19 cents and was not in a bear market.

Twelve months after election day Bitcoin was higher all three times, and the calendar year after a midterm was green all three times. The first three months were red in two of the three.

THE REASON

IT IS THE **HALVING**, NOT THE VOTE

Bitcoin's halvings landed in 2012, 2016, 2020 and 2024. All four were US presidential election years. That is a coincidence of timing, but it locks the two calendars together. A midterm always falls about two to two and a half years after a halving, which is where Bitcoin's bear markets have ended.

MIDTERM	ELECTION DAY, DAYS AFTER THE CYCLE TOP	BEAR LOW, DAYS AFTER THE CYCLE TOP	ELECTION DAY, AFTER THE LAST HALVING
2014	day 339	day 410	706 days
2018	day 324	day 363	850 days
2022	day 363	day 376	911 days
2026	day 393	day 268	927 days

2026 low is the lowest so far, 1 July 2026.

In 2014, 2018 and 2022, election day fell on day 324 to 363 after the cycle top and the low came on day 363 to 410. The midterm does not cause the bottom. The two share a calendar. If the halving cycle changes, the midterm pattern has no reason to survive on its own.

2026

WHAT MAKES 2026 DIFFERENT



when each bear's lowest price came, measured from that year's midterm election day.

The lowest price of this bear so far is \$57,735 on 1 July 2026, 125 days before the 3 November midterm. None of the three earlier bears bottomed before its midterm.

If the pattern holds, Bitcoin makes a new low under \$57,735 after 3 November. The earlier lows came 13 to 71 days after election day, which would point to mid-November through mid-January. **If the pattern breaks,** July was the bottom, about four months early.

The limits. Three midterms cannot prove a rule, and all three sit on the same four-year halving rhythm, so they are closer to one observation than three. The stock record is strong but says nothing about Bitcoin directly. The useful line is a price, \$57,735, not a date.

Data pinned 5 October 2026. Bitstamp BTC/USD, Yahoo ^GSPC. Scripts: Midterms/mt_study.py, Midterms/mt_more.py, Midterms/mt_charts.py. This is education, not financial advice.

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